



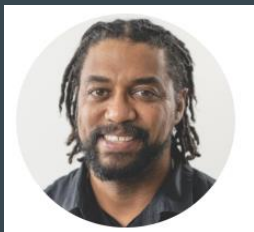
Association of Bay Area Governments Metropolitan Transportation Commission

Metro Planning and Policy Division

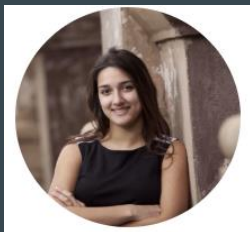
UC Berkeley CYPLAN 101 Fall 2026

Wednesday, August 26, 2026

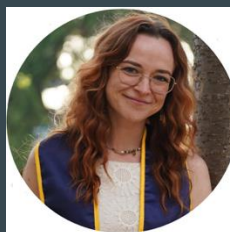
Speaker Introductions



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Today's Agenda

I. About Us (20 Mins)

About the Metropolitan Transportation Commission

About the Metro Planning & Policy Division

II. Project Mentorship (20 Mins)

Project Introductions

Process, Schedule, Evaluation

Opportunities

III. Q&A (10 Mins)

Urban Analytics

Career Advice

About Us



About MTC / ABAG

Mission: MTC's mission is to advance shared local and regional priorities for transportation, housing and the environment.

Vision: A vibrant Bay Area that is connected, equitable and sustainable.

Planning & Policy

MTC leads long-term transportation and land-use planning to promote sustainable growth across nine Bay Area counties. MTC allocates funds for transportation projects and is governed by a diverse 21-member policy board representing all counties.

Mobility

The agency manages toll revenues via BATA to maintain and operate state-owned bridges effectively. MTC oversees programs like Clipper card, FasTrak, and the 511 system to enhance transit fare collection and traffic information.

Housing and Energy

The agency allocates housing needs, funds and coordinates affordable housing production, provides support services for Bay Area jurisdictions to comply with housing laws, and offers energy efficiency discounts, rebates, and technical assistance for the Bay Area.



MTC-ABAG **Equity** Platform

Definition of Equity

MTC defines equity as inclusion enabling everyone to participate, prosper, and reach full potential in the Bay Area.

Focus on Underserved Groups

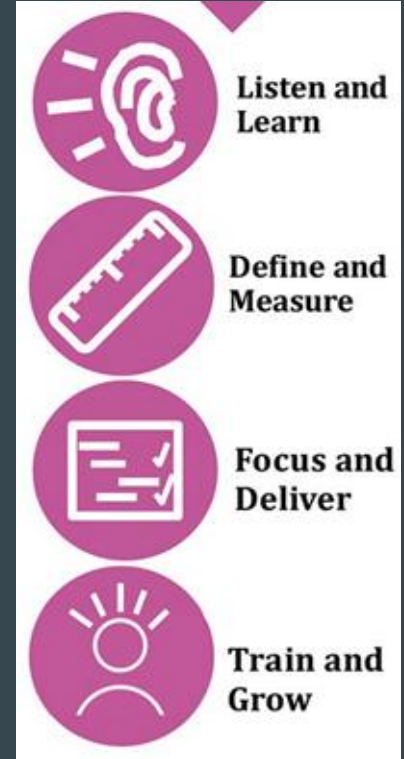
MTC prioritizes investments and policies supporting low-income and marginalized communities to ensure fair access.

Equity as Core Value

Equity guides MTC's mission, vision, and daily operations to build a fair transportation system for all.

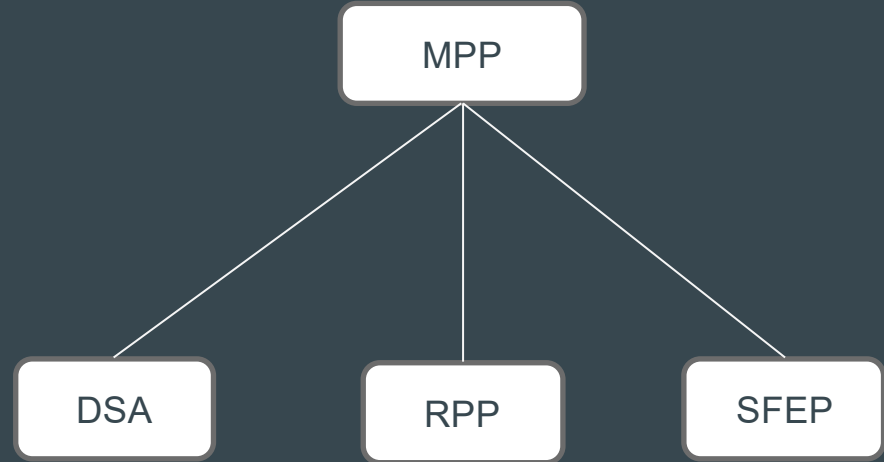
Accountability and Collaboration

MTC uses data-driven policies and collaboration to address access gaps and improve mobility continuously.



Metro Planning & Policy

1. One of the seven divisions within MTC
2. Data Strategy & Analytics (DSA)
3. Regional Planning Program (RPP)
4. San Francisco Estuary Partnership (SFEP)



Our Core Skills + Tools



ArcGIS

Spatial Analysis & Map Making

ArcGIS Pro / ArcGIS Online / Adobe Illustrator



Interactive Dashboards

Tableau Desktop & Cloud / PowerBI



Data Accessibility/Management

Socrata / ArcGIS Online



Intermediate to Advanced Analytics

Mode Analytics / SQL / Python



GitHub

Process Documentation

GitHub / Lucid Charts

I. Data & Technical Skills

Data governance fundamentals (standards, quality, metadata)

Analysis + Visualization (Python, Tableau/Mode Analytics, ArcGIS)

SQL and enterprise data platform literacy

Rapid adoption of new tools and methods

II. Analytical Skills

Critical thinking and problem framing

Identifying trends, patterns, and insights

Applying data to planning, policy, and operations

III. Strategic & Programmatic Skills

Enterprise mindset + Hub & Spoke collaboration

Project and program management

Change management and analytics enablement

IV. Collaboration & Communication Skills

Data storytelling for varied audiences

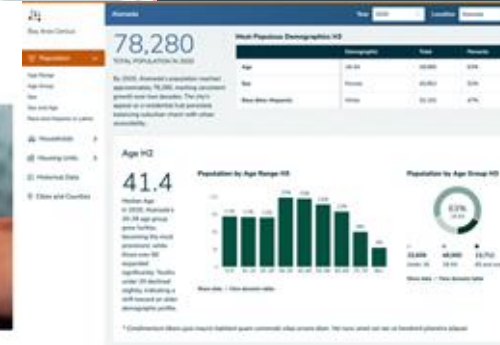
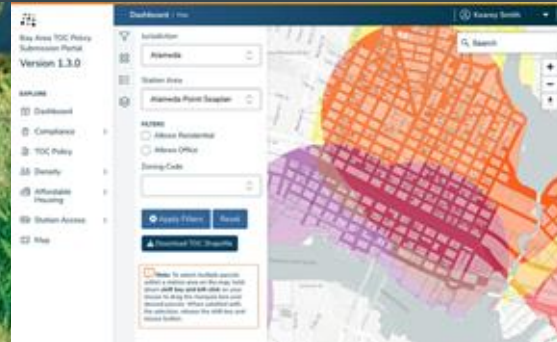
Cross-department relationship building

Clear documentation + knowledge sharing

Effective stakeholder engagement

Data Strategy at MTC

Key Programs/ Projects Supported/ Major Deliverables



Data Strategy + Analytics Section (DSA)

Sample Products

Vital Signs

<https://vitalsigns.mtc.ca.gov/>

Bay Area Census

<https://census.bayareametro.gov/>

Bay Area Housing and Land Use Viewer

<https://housing.abag.ca.gov/landusemap>

BAHFA Eviction Study Dashboard

<https://bahfa-eviction-dashboard.mtcanalytics.org/?embedId=map>

Mentorship Program



MTC Mentorship Program

Mentorship for the course final project

1. Informal mentorship with MTC MPP staff to support your course final project
2. Bi-weekly or as-needed check-ins throughout the semester
3. MTC to provide some high level project ideas
4. Present your final projects to staff at MTC's office in San Francisco



MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 1: Regional Housing Needs Allocation (RHNA)

Question: What methodologies should ABAG consider when allocating the share of Regional Housing Needs Determination (RHND) to each local government in the region for RHNA Cycle 7?

Potential resources:

1. General information about RHNA from ABAG website:
 - a. <https://abag.ca.gov/our-work/housing/rhna-regional-housing-needs-allocation>
2. Review the final RHNA plan for Cycle 6:
 - a. https://abag.ca.gov/sites/default/files/documents/2025-06/Final%20RHNA%20Methodology%20Report%202023-2031_Jun2025_Update_0.pdf

MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 2: Defining Equity Priority Communities (EPCs)

Question: What methodology should MTC/ABAG use to define Equity Priority Communities (EPCs)?

Potential resources:

1. General information about EPCs from MTC/ABAG website:
 - a. <https://mtc.ca.gov/planning/transportation/access-equity-mobility/equity-priority-communities/mtc-abags-plan-bay-area-2050-equity-priority-communities-update>

MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 3: SB 79 Transit-Oriented Development and Upzoning

Question: Compare some number of SB 79-affected counties, create maps and charts that show differences in TOD capacity, transit quality, and expected housing yield.

Potential resources:

1. General information about SB 79 from ABAG website:
 - a. <https://abag.ca.gov/our-work/housing/regional-housing-technical-assistance/senate-bill-79-2025>
2. Information about SB 79 from California YIMBY (advocacy group):
 - a. <https://cayimby.org/legislation/sb-79/>

MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 4: Daytime Population

Question: Visualize how the daytime population changes across the Bay Area at various levels of geospatial granularity. How has this changed over time, and what are the current trends?

Potential resources:

1. LEHD Data: <https://lehd.ces.census.gov/data/>

MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 5: Transit Fiscal Cliff

Question: What would happen if transit service is significantly cut?

Potential resources:

1. LEHD Data: <https://lehd.ces.census.gov/data/>
2. NTD Data: <https://www.transit.dot.gov/ntd>
3. Census Data: <https://www.census.gov/en.html>
4. PeMS Data: <https://pems.dot.ca.gov/>

MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 6: Builder's Remedy

Question: How could Builder's Remedy affect our region?

Potential resources:

1. ABAG Housing Element Noncompliance: <https://abag.ca.gov/technical-assistance/housing-element-compliance-incentives-consequences>
2. HCD APR Dashboard: <https://www.hcd.ca.gov/housing-open-data-tools/apr-dashboard>

MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 7: CalEnviroScreen Disadvantaged Communities

Question: Examine the CES 5.0 methodology and impacts and propose an alternative methodology

Potential resources:

1. CA OEHHA: <https://oehha.ca.gov/calenviroscreen/report/calenviroscreen-50>

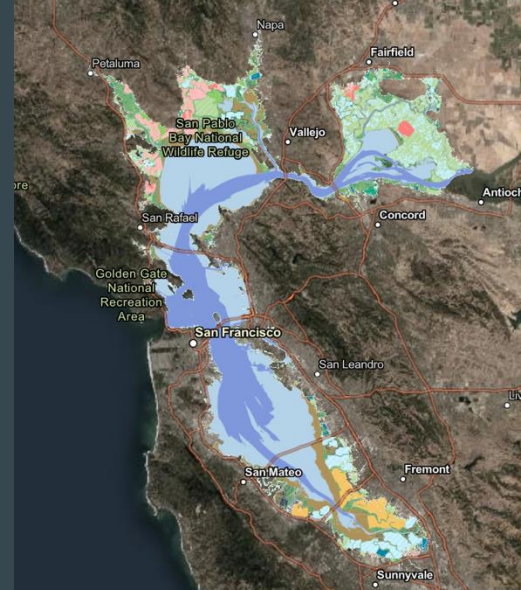
MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 8: Identifying Flood Risk Reduction from Marshes

Question: What level of flood risk reduction are wetlands providing to communities around the Bay? How are these benefits distributed?

Potential resources:

1. Offshore height of 100-year waves and height at the back of marshes in the Bay Area, developed by the Baylands Resilience Framework
2. Shoreline vulnerability index, developed by BCDC
3. Community vulnerability, developed by BCDC



MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 9: El Niño and Sea Level Rise

Question: What might the impact of El Niño be on coastal flooding in the Bay Area this year (estimated additional 1 ft of SLR)?

Resources:

1. [2025 WRMP lidar data](#)
2. [San Francisco Bay Trail](#)
3. [WRMP Shoreline Access Dataset](#)

Potential directions:

1. Identifying vulnerable transportation infrastructure
2. Modeling inundation of shoreline public access points or trails

MTC Mentorship Program Ideas

Idea 10: Estimating Visitation to the Shoreline

Question: How can we use free and accessible data to estimate visitation counts to the shoreline over time?

Potential resources:

1. INaturalist
2. eBird
3. Flickr photographs
4. Google Maps reviews

DSA Mentorship Program

Process, Schedule, Evaluation

Process & Schedule

1. Student teams to submit proposals to address one of the ideas
2. MTC staff review proposals, select teams, assign MTC mentor
3. Bi-Weekly mentorship sessions:
 - a. Student teams and MTC mentor to schedule bi-weekly or as needed check-ins
4. Midterm submission
5. Final submission

Deliverables, evaluation, and schedule should be consistent with the rest of the course.



DSA Mentorship Program

Opportunities and Benefits of Mentorship

1. Solve real world problems
2. Get a feel for working in urban analytics
3. Networking for job opportunities at MTC and beyond



Q&A

